

Question:
A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?
Answer Choices:
A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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**Finding reasoning paths : **

- 1 . Persistent sadness with a history of decision-making difficulties and hope lessness -> Major Depressive Disorder
- 2 . Worsening suicidal ideations and increased energy -> Possible Bipolar Disorder
- 3 . Unhappy life events and worsening psychological states -> Mental Health Disorders
- 4 . Decision-making difficulties and hope lessness -> Major Depressive Disorder

**Reasoning Process : **

- 1 . **Persistent Sadness and Decision-Making Difficulties : ** The patient has reported feeling sad for as long as he can remember and difficulty making decisions . This suggests a long-standing issue with decision-making , which is a common symptom of depression .
- 2 . **Hopelessness and Decision-Making Difficulties : ** The patient 's report of hopelessness and difficulty making decisions is indicative of depressive symptoms . Major Depressive Disorder is characterized by these symptoms , especially when they persist .
- 3 . **Worsening Suicidal Ideations : ** The recent worsening of suicidal ideations is a critical factor . This is a concerning symptom that often accompanies severe depression and can indicate an increased risk of suicide .
- 4 . **Sleep and Job Functionality : ** The patient reports sleeping enough and maintaining a job , which suggests stable sleep patterns and a degree of stability in daily life despite his psychological distress .
- 5 . **History of Sadness and Worsening State : ** The combination of persistent sadness , worsening psychological states , and suicidal ideations over the past 2 weeks is consistent with a depressive episode , likely in the context of Major Depressive Disorder .
- 6 . **Rule Out Mania or Psychosis : ** While the patient 's recent report of increased energy could theoretically suggest bipolar disorder , the predominant symptoms (persistent sadness , hopelessness , and suicidal ideations) are more consistent with Major Depressive Disorder . Manic symptoms are typically associated with significant energy increases , increased activity , and sometimes euphoria , which are not described in this case .

**Conclusion : **

Based on the reasoning , the patient is most likely experiencing a depressive episode , possibly part of Major Depressive Disorder . The symptoms of persistent sadness , decision-making difficulties , hopelessness , and worsening suicidal ideations align strongly with this diagnosis . Additionally , the worsening state over the past 2 weeks further supports the presence of a depressive episode .

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<answer>
The patient is at risk for double depression .
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